

Normally, there are three common ways of using PHP:

- Desktop (GUI) applications
- Web sites and web applications (server-side scripting), and
- Command line scripting

Once you write the PHP script, the rest of the work is simple. Assuming that you already have a web browser, and depending on your operating system setup, you either have a web server for web-space, or you can rent this from a hosting company. After following these simple steps, you can simply upload your PHP code on your rented server and see the results in your browser. PHP can be compiled from the original source code if Microsoft Visual Studio is already installed on the local drive.

PHP installation can be categorised into two parts:

Windows installer: Here you use the MSI technology of the Wix Toolkit. In this method, PHP is installed and configured with PECL and other built-in extensions. The Windows Installer also configures many other popular web servers like Apache, Xitami and IIS.

Normal install: While running the MSI installer, follow the instructions in the installation wizard.

While in some servers PHP has a direct module interface (such as Microsoft Internet Information Server, iPlanet servers, Apache and Netscape) many other servers support ISAPI. However, PHP does not have a module support for web servers. You can host PHP application with the CGI or Fast CGI processor.

It is often used for command-line scripting with the command line executable. PHP is an advanced scripting language and can be used to write desktop GUI applications, making use of the PHP-GTK extension. Writing desktop GUI applications is different from creating web pages. In a GUI application, PHP manages windows and objects, but no HTML is produced.

Silent install: Its method is helpful for system administrators. The following command is useful during the installation of PHP in silent mode:

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msiexec.exe /i php-VERSION-win32-install.msi /q  
Another useful formula to install PHP is:
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